

# Baroque Revival

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**B**y the late 19th century, students of architecture flocked to the École des Beaux-Arts from all over the world. The first American to attend was Richard Morris Hunt (1827–95), who helped found the American Institute of Architects in 1857. One of his many designs was the façade and Great Hall of the Metropolitan Museum of Art (opposite, opened in 1902) and the pedestal of the Statue of Liberty (1882–4). His grand mansions became identified with America's Gilded Age and demonstrate what became variously known as the baroque revival, neo-baroque, Imperial style or, in France, Second Empire architecture (and in Britain, Edwardian baroque). In France, the baroque was an essential part of architects' learning at the École des Beaux-Arts, and aspects of the style emerged in buildings around Europe. These include: City Hall in Belfast (1898–1906), designed by Alfred Brumwell Thomas (1866–1948); the Reichstag (Parliament) Building in Berlin (1889–98), designed by Paul Wallot (1841–1912); and the Piccadilly Hotel in London (1905–8), designed by Norman Shaw (1831–1912).

